Table 1: Air Quality and Synthetic Mortality: County–Day Panel

Dependent variable: Synthetic mortality Specification	(1) Baseline TWFE	(2) Lagged AQI	(3) CBSA interaction
AQI_{it}	0.5277***	0.3048***	0.5336***
	(0.0102)	(0.0041)	(0.0194)
$\text{AQI}_{i,t-1}$		0.3687***	
		(0.0045)	
$\text{AQI}_{it} \times \text{CBSA}_i$			-0.0067
			(0.0195)
County fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Date fixed effects	Yes	Yes	Yes
Observations	13,746	13,746	13,746
County clusters	41	41	41
R^2	0.7555	0.8372	0.7555
Within R^2	0.5187	0.6795	0.5187

Notes: Ordinary least squares with county and calendar-date fixed effects throughout. Standard errors clustered by county are reported in parentheses. $^{***}p < 0.01$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{*}p < 0.10$. Model (2) uses the previous calendar day's AQI and may have fewer observations. CBSA indicates whether the county belongs to a Core-Based Statistical Area; the indicator's main effect is absorbed by county fixed effects. The dependent variable is SYNTHETIC, not actual mortality. Estimates describe associations, not causal effects.